

Dhanai Holtzclaw

Art Direction · Product Design

Brand systems · campaign craft · product UX · AI generative creative · concept to shipped

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SUMMARY

I'm a creative who likes being close to the work, from the initial idea through actually making things. I've spent 20 years across broadcast, advertising, web, and product. I built a hand-drawn apparel brand to \$3.8M in sales and learned to write code when designing wasn't enough. These days I work across generative, product design, and Next.js.

EXPERIENCE

2020 — Present

Takeout Order — Founder & Creative / Product Lead

- Built the brand end to end, including identity, voice, and a full hand-drawn product catalog, and scaled it to \$3.8M in lifetime sales.
- Wrote and art-directed campaigns across paid social, web, email, and packaging; ran continuous creative testing where concepts were the primary growth lever.
- Designed and shipped the B2B fulfillment portal operators use daily, including Shopify ingest, labels, and an order state machine, when off-the-shelf tools broke at scale.
- Directed hundreds of shoots, live-action and AI-generated, building a repeatable system for on-brand generative video and imagery.

2026 — Present

Doomsy — Founder · Product Design & Creative

- Designed and shipped a creative feed product for brands with catalog ingest, a private feed, a like/pass loop, and natural-language image edits.
- Owned product UX and creative quality bar: on-brand photos and reels without a shoot, with taste and systems thinking in the same surface.

2026 — Present

Well Shucks — Founder & Creative Director

- Launched a second apparel brand from positioning through storefront: "tragically nostalgic: vintage children's illustrations for adults with behavioral issues."

2013 — 2019

DJcity — Creative Director

- Owned brand, campaign, and product creative for a DJ music platform across six years, building and running the creative function in-house.
- Directed DJcity TV on-air identity and partnered daily with engineering to take creative from concept to shipped product surfaces.

2010 — 2013

Ciplex — Creative Director

- Designed and art-directed web experiences for ArcLight Cinemas and Grauman's Chinese Theatre, plus brand, campaign, and digital work for small-business clients.

EARLIER CAREER

Agency and studio work across interactive, brand, and editorial design during the Flash-to-web transition.

Mego — Creative Director	2009 — 2010
Getback — Art Director	2008 — 2009
Hello Design — Lead Designer	2007 — 2008
Cytek Studios — Lead Designer	2005 — 2007
Resultz — Interactive Designer	2003 — 2005

SKILLS

CREATIVE Art direction, brand identity, campaign concepting, copywriting, editorial & layout, hand illustration, motion (After Effects)
PRODUCT Product UX, information architecture, flows & prototypes, design systems, usability judgment, Figma
AI CREATIVE Generative video & image direction: Seedance, Kling, Nano Banana, Flux; AI as a production tool
DESIGN TOOLS Figma, Photoshop, Illustrator, After Effects, Premiere, InDesign, Procreate
BUILD Next.js, React, TypeScript, Shopify, Meta Ads; ships production software solo when needed